

Yangzong Baima

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Education

University College Dublin 2025.09 - 2026.08

MSc in Human-Computer Interaction Dublin, Ireland

GPA: 3.5/4.2 (expected)

Coursework: Research Methods, Quantitative Data Analysis, User-Centred Design, Information Visualisation, Large Language Models & Methods (LLMs), Social Network Analysis, Psychological Perspectives in HCI

Tongji University 2018.08 - 2023.07

BEng in Civil Engineering Shanghai, China

Coursework: Probability & Mathematical Statistics, Finite Element Method, Civil Engineering Informatization, C++ Programming, Structural Mechanics, Construction Law & Regulations, Principles of Management, Engineering Economics & Cost Estimation, and more

Work Experience

Tibet Xingguang Social Work Service Center 2024.11 - 2025.05

Operations Specialist (Eldercare Services) Lhasa, China

- **Data Cleaning & Restructuring:** The organization inherited a nursing home whose records had been left in significant disorder by the previous operator; independently cleaned and reclassified the data in Stata, verifying each record manually.
- **Daily Operations & Government Liaison:** Managed the nursing home's day-to-day operations and routine liaison with the Civil Affairs Bureau.
- **Process Automation:** Coordinated all participating units during a volunteer-service competition; built an Excel VBA tool to batch-migrate registration data into a standardized scoring sheet, replacing a manual copy-paste process, with documentation for reuse in future events.

Wiseweb 2024.05 - 2024.08

Corpus Engineer Lhasa, China

- Contributed to a corpus-building project for a medical translation tool used in Tibetan hospital settings; drawing on fluency in Tibetan (Ü-Tsang and Chamdo dialects) and Chinese, reviewed over 4,000 Tibetan-Chinese bilingual medical-domain data entries.
- Organized Tibet University students to record Tibetan-Chinese bilingual and dialect corpus audio, manually verifying audio-to-text alignment.

Project Experience

Precision Policy Targeting: Tackling Energy Poverty Among Seniors Living Alone 2026.01

UCD MSc HCI Coursework Project Dublin, Ireland

- **Background:** A single indicator cannot capture the real hardship faced by older people living alone; built a county-level “Energy Poverty Index” model using CSO (Central Statistics Office of Ireland) census data.
- **Method:** Combined the rate/number of people living alone, median income, and the Q1/Q3 income ratio into a standardized, weighted vulnerability score, and built an interactive dashboard.
- **Output:** Designed a “Policy Intervention Matrix” splitting Ireland's 26 counties into four quadrants by economic vulnerability × seasonal heating dependency (Q1/Q3 ratio, used as a proxy for housing structural efficiency), each matched to a specific policy tool (fuel allowance + retrofit grants / income support / tax incentives / continued monitoring); the prototype was demoed at CSO headquarters.

PainScape: Chronic Pain Community Workshop Toolkit 2026.05 - 2026.08

UCD MSc HCI Capstone Project Dublin, Ireland

- **Background:** A project run with a European chronic pain community; the core problem was low engagement within the patient community and members' reluctance to speak up.
- **Research:** Designed and distributed a survey, combined with workshops and a literature review, then ran qualitative and quantitative analysis on the survey and interview data.

- **Iteration:** The design went through two rounds of iteration and was finalized as an offline toolkit used at the community's recurring recruitment events.
- **Result:** The project was well received, and next steps toward real-world deployment are being discussed with the supervisor and project partners.

AI Product Exploration & Practice

2026 - Present

Personal Projects

- **Extension Design:** Focused on the hidden energy and water cost behind LLM usage; built a Manifest V3 browser extension that estimates and visualizes the energy/water cost of AI conversations in real time, with a lightweight, playful animation (an animal drinking water) to reinforce user awareness of AI's environmental cost — positioned as an educational tool rather than one that enforces behavior change.
- **Product Practice:** Independently built a Dublin rental-research tool supporting local entry of listings, commute-time calculation, comparison and status tracking across multiple listings, with all data stored locally; users can optionally call an API to parse Xiaohongshu listing posts, automatically extracting price, address, billing terms, and other details to reduce manual work.

Volunteer Teaching — Shabulang Village, Huangnan Tibetan

2024

Autonomous Prefecture, Qinghai

- Took on daily teaching duties during a 3-month volunteer teaching placement, while also managing the class schedule and overseeing teaching quality — regularly conducting classroom observation spot-checks and reviewing teachers' lesson-prep records.

Campus Experience

- Received an Ethnic Minority Scholarship multiple times during undergraduate studies
- Won Second Prize in the “Civil Cup” Debate Competition, Tongji University College of Civil Engineering
- Selected as a student representative to attend the 2026 Society of Women Engineers (SWE) Annual Conference
- Coursework project stood out and was invited for an in-person presentation at the headquarters of the Central Statistics Office (CSO) of Ireland

Skills

Languages: Chinese (native), Tibetan (native), English (IELTS 7.5)

Software: Figma, Axure, Python, SQL, Stata, VBA, Tableau, Power BI, Microsoft Office

AI-Related: Completed coursework on large language models (UCD MSc HCI); proficient with AI coding tools; familiar with the principles behind mainstream AI agent tooling such as LangChain and RAG, as well as AI product validation methods including layered prompt design, badcase-driven iteration, and A/B testing; able to learn quickly and independently build prototypes.

Product Methods: Skilled in user research, competitive analysis, requirements breakdown, prioritization, PRD writing, and prototyping; able to map key user paths and edge cases around a core problem and drive iteration from data feedback.

Personal Statement

An HCI master's student with an undergraduate background in civil engineering, combining engineering systems thinking with user research and product design skills. Long-term research and practice in real-world settings with vulnerable and underserved groups (older adults, chronic pain patients, and rural students), able to independently carry a project from structured data to a shipped visualization, and from qualitative insight to a product solution. A trilingual background (Tibetan, Chinese, English) gives me a natural advantage in communicating with and researching diverse groups, further evidenced by a Level 1-A Putonghua Proficiency Certificate and an IELTS score of 7.5. I also maintain an ongoing interest in the capability boundaries and responsible design of large-language-model products (such as data quality, transparency, and user trust), and have been building first-hand experience through corpus-engineering work and personal AI projects.

Portfolio

Personal Portfolio & Project Showcase: pemaa817.github.io